MC 451 White Paper rubric

250 points. Due Friday, December 18, 11:59 PM.

How this is scored. Add the points from each row; the total is out of 250. A first attempt is graded forgivingly: a part that is there but incomplete earns partial credit, and 0 is kept for a part that is missing. Length and the curve are under the grid. Submissions are unlimited before the deadline, so you can revise and submit again.

- Dated step, Friday, December 4: push your full coded dataset to your project repository. Your Methods reports stability from your pilot re-code; there is no second re-code. Nothing about your analysis is due that day.
- Submit one ZIP file holding the paper PDF and your AI-use log, plus the live GitHub Pages URL pasted into the submission; one without the other is incomplete. The row weights are the same as the White Paper rubric on the Phase V page.
- Sources: textbooks, industry reports, and trade coverage count toward the twelve but not toward the eight peer-reviewed articles.
- References: one citation style of your choosing (APA, MLA, Chicago, and IEEE are all acceptable), named on the first page and applied consistently. Each entry carries enough detail to find the source.

White Paper, 250 points

Criterion	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Introduction 30 points	**30 points.** States the question and why it is worth asking, situated in the literature. The theory does work in the argument and sets up something the study can actually deliver.	**23 to 29 points.** The question and its importance are clear, but the theory is named and then not used.	**15 to 22 points.** The question is there, but the literature is gestured at instead of cited, or the introduction promises more than the study can show.	**0 to 14 points.** No clear question.

Criterion	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Methods 60 points	**60 points.** Another researcher could repeat the study from it: the unit of analysis, the sampling plan as executed, data provenance (source, date range, what was excluded and why), how the codebook was built, what you did with the cases that did not sort themselves, the wrangling steps, and the coder reliability report (your stability figure, how it was produced, and the single-coder limitation named as such).	**45 to 59 points.** Complete, but one piece is thin, most often the reliability report or what was excluded and why.	**30 to 44 points.** Two or more pieces missing, or the plan is described as intended instead of as executed.	**0 to 29 points.** Too little to repeat the study.
Results 50 points	**50 points.** Reports without interpreting: descriptive statistics for every coded variable, the test with its degrees of freedom, p-value and effect size, at least three qualitative themes each with examples from your material, and at least two figures and one table, numbered, captioned, given alt text, and referred to in the text by number.	**38 to 49 points.** All parts are there, but a figure or table is never referred to in the text, a figure has no alt text, or interpretation creeps in.	**25 to 37 points.** The effect size, the themes or the figures are missing.	**0 to 24 points.** Results are missing, or described in words without the numbers.

Criterion	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Discussion 50 points	**50 points.** Answers the question the introduction asked, separates statistical significance from practical size, describes the effect size accurately, and states the limits honestly, including the single-coder design and the second-coder counterfactual (what double-coding would have added, and which finding is most at risk).	**38 to 49 points.** Answers the question and states limits, but the counterfactual or the significance-versus-size point is thin.	**25 to 37 points.** Restates the results without answering the question, or inflates a small effect.	**0 to 24 points.** Missing.
Abstract and references 20 points	**20 points.** An abstract of 150 to 250 words carrying the question, method, finding and implication; at least twelve sources, at least eight of them peer-reviewed articles reporting original research; one citation style, named on the first page and used throughout, with every in-text citation in the list and every list entry cited.	**15 to 19 points.** One gap: the abstract skips one of its four parts, or the list and the in-text citations disagree in a few places.	**10 to 14 points.** Fewer than twelve sources or fewer than eight peer-reviewed articles, or an abstract under 150 words, which usually means the finding or its implication is missing.	**0 to 9 points.** No abstract or no reference list.

Criterion	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Reproducibility and publication 25 points	**25 points.** Renders from source to PDF with no errors, every figure, table and number comes from the code, and it is live at a public address.	**19 to 24 points.** Renders and is live, but one number in the prose is typed in instead of produced by the code.	**13 to 18 points.** Several numbers or a figure pasted in instead of generated.	**0 to 12 points.** Does not render from source.
Reflection 15 points	**15 points.** One specific paragraph naming what proved harder than expected, where a rule was unclear in practice, what the data could not answer, and what a second attempt would change. It is graded on candor and precision, not on whether the study went well.	**11 to 14 points.** Specific, but skips one of the four.	**8 to 10 points.** General ("I learned a lot about research").	**0 to 7 points.** Missing.

Length and the curve

Length: 3,500 to 5,000 words from the introduction through the reflection. Word counts cover your own writing, not the title, headings, tables, references, figure captions, code, or output, and writing more than the range never costs points. Scores on work that shows effort are adjusted with the course's curve: your final percentage is 25 percent plus 75 percent of your rubric percentage, so 50 of 100 on the rubric becomes 62.5. Work at two-thirds or more of the minimum length counts as showing effort.